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# Greenville

Written by

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Writer's notes:
This is inspired from a TTRPG so the narrator should be more of a DM type of voice. Also, I am aware I got lazy and didn't put (V.O) for all those lines.

Peoples
Narrator
Cooper
Alex
Mike
Miss. Keller
Juniper
Pond guy/ Fishie

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1 EXT. GREENVILLE - AFTERNOON 1

NARRATOR
The year is 1992. Because it is, it’s when this strange, fleeting, inevitable moment takes place.

A SHOT OF DOWNTOWN brick buildings, modest storefronts.

CITY HALL, a weathered plaque reading “GREENVILLE.”

NARRATOR (cont'd)
The place, Greenville, Illinois. A place you won’t find on a map. And why would you?

PEOPLE walk the sidewalks.

A BUTCHER unloads meat from the back of a truck.

NARRATOR (cont'd)
It’s a town people leave.

A CAR passes beneath an overpass and disappears from view.

NARRATOR (cont'd)
A stop between childhood and the rest of the world. It’s a town of routines—

POLICE OFFICERS sit in a cruiser, coffee cups balanced on the dash.

NARRATOR (cont'd)
The same cops at the same station,

A GROCERY STORE window displays a SALE SIGN: PAPER CLIPS.

NARRATOR (cont'd)
The same grocery store on the corner of Main Street, its windows always the same shade of beige. Nothing ever changes here.

A beat.

NARRATOR (cont'd)
Until it does.

2 EXT. POPLAR COURT – 5:00 A.M. - BEAT 1 2

Mathew Parker (15) pedals a BIKE down the empty street.

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The back rack is loaded with NEWSPAPERS, bundled tight.

NARRATOR
Every morning at five a.m., Mathew Parker does the same thing.

TIRES hiss against wet pavement.

Mathew tosses a paper.

It lands cleanly on a porch.

Another throw. Another porch.

NARRATOR (cont'd)
He rides fast. Efficient. Trying to beat the quiet before it notices him.

The street is still.

Too still.

A DOG barks somewhere far away.

Trees rustle in the early breeze.

Mathew slows.

He hears something.

At first, it’s barely there.

Almost nothing.

He stops pedaling.

NARRATOR (cont'd)
At this hour, Greenville isn’t supposed to make noise.

A faint sound drifts through the air.

CRYING.

Mathew turns his head.

At the end of Poplar Court stands an OLD HOUSE —

paint peeling, windows dark, porch sagging inward.

The house kids dare each other to walk past.

The house no one stays near for long.

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NARRATOR (cont'd)
The house has been empty for as long as anyone remembers.

The crying comes again.

Clearer now.

From inside.

Mathew puts one foot on the ground.

His bike tilts beside him.

NARRATOR (cont'd)
But this morning, it isn't empty.

Mathew stares at the house.

Unsure. Afraid. Listening.

NARRATOR (cont'd)
Mathew doesn't know who's in there. He doesn't know why they're crying.

A beat.

NARRATOR (cont'd)
He only knows that someone is.

Mathew stares at the house.

The crying continues.

CUT TO BLACK.

NARRATOR (V.O.)
But this isn't his story.

SMASH CUT TO:

3 EXT. MAIN STREET - 7:16 A.M. 3

COOPER GREEN (16) pedals fast down the street, backpack bouncing.

He takes a sharp RIGHT TURN.

As he does, CHRIS (14) grabs onto the back rack of Cooper's bike.

They sync up perfectly — cruising.

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They pass STONE'S (15) HOUSE.

Chris presses a button on his WALKIE-TALKIE.

WALKIE-TALKIE BEEP

4 INT. STONE'S BEDROOM – CONTINUOUS 4

MIKE STONE jolts upright.

The walkie-talkie BEEP echoes again.

This is his 7:45 A.M. alarm.

Mike bolts for the door.

5 EXT. STONE'S HOUSE – CONTINUOUS 5

Mike sprints out, hops onto his BLACK BMX — RED FLAMES painted on the frame by Cooper.

He pedals hard.

6 EXT. MAIN STREET – CONTINUOUS 6

Cooper and Chris keep cruising.

Mike catches up, falling into formation.

Three bikes. One rhythm.

7 EXT. HIGH SCHOOL – MORNING 7

They skid to a stop at the bike racks.

Stone struggles with his lock.

It won't cooperate.

The bell RINGS.

Cooper and Chris exchange a look — then head inside.

Stone is left wrestling the lock.

8 INT. HIGH SCHOOL – ENTRANCE – CONTINUOUS 8

Students flood in.

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NARRATOR (V.O.)
Do you want to go to school?

Okay. Understood.

First period— no, sorry. Before that.

9 INT. HIGH SCHOOL - HALLWAY - CONTINUOUS 9

ALEX walks alone.

He blends into the crowd of students pouring through the doors.

NARRATOR (V.O.)
As Alex walks into school alone, he’s impatient.

Alex bumps into LUCAS BEERY.

Alex stumbles back.

Lucas doesn’t.

NARRATOR (V.O.) (cont'd)
Now, Lucas Beery used to be Cooper’s cuddly bear.
Huge Labrador energy.
Best friend back in kindergarten.

Lucas towers over Alex.

NARRATOR (V.O.) (cont'd)
Rumor has it he wore a size thirteen shoe in sixth grade.

Lucas cracks his knuckles.

NARRATOR (V.O.) (cont'd)
Now Lucas is the school bully.
Banned from school sports for unsportsmanlike behavior.

Alex backs up into someone else.

NARRATOR (V.O.) (cont'd)
You don’t want to know.

It is Mike who intimates Lucas.

NARRATOR (V.O.) (cont'd)
You and I are still strangers.
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NARRATOR (V.O.) (cont'd)
Trauma dumping is more of a second-date thing for me.

Lucas backs out of their way.

NARRATOR (V.O.) (cont'd)
Nothing happens.
Yet.
My apologies. No drama… yet.

Alex slips away into the crowd.

NARRATOR (V.O.) (cont'd)
Don’t worry.
I’ll tell you everything.

We watch Cooper and Mike walk their own way.

NARRATOR (V.O.) (cont'd)
Scout’s honor.

10 INT. MISS KELLER’S CLASS - DAY - BEAT 2 10

NARRATOR (V.O.)
Now, let’s check in with Cooper and Mike in science class. Miss Keller is a woman of science, teaching a lecture on electromagnetic fields. Let’s refer to them as EMFs from now on.

Miss. Keller opens her mouth.

MISS.KELLER
Can anyone tell me what they think is the number one cause of EMFs?

NARRATOR (V.O.)
Cooper knows this is a trick question. Miss Keller wants a supernatural answer, too, because being a skeptic is her favorite thing.

Mike raises his hand a little too quickly.

MISS.KELLER
Mr. Brown?

MIKE BROWN
Um... is it the Pentagon files?

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COOPER (V.O.)
Good move, Mike. Make it about something scarier than ghosts—politics.

MISS.KELLER
No, Brown. This has nothing to do with the CIA.
How about you, Mr. Green?

COOPER
I think the answer you want is limestone.

MISS.KELLER
Correct! Limestone conducts and stores so much energy that most 'haunted places' are made of limestone. Wouldn’t you agree, Mr. Green?

COOPER
(to himself)
This has to be against some kind of school relationship policy.

MISS.KELLER
Although class, even though Mr. Green here worships pseudo-science, it’s at least a science he can hold onto. Fiction is such a great brain exercise.

COOPER
What proof do you need?

MISS.KELLER
Mr. Green, the day you have something I can physically see, I’ll let you sleep in the lab researching it.

COOPER
(under his breath)
Great. In order to prove Bigfoot exists, I have to do a school project?

11 EXT. GREENVILLE - DAY 11

We get a birds eye view over the town of Greenville.

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NARRATOR
Actually, reader, now that I have you here, let me tell you more about the origins of the town. It was founded by a church that practiced inclusion and diversity, named Greenville after the original church that was burned by a neighboring village. The town grew up steeped in religion, and most families attend one church or another, the most central being Green Methodist Church.
The town is also a farming community, with miles of cornfields extending out from every side of the small village. These cornfields are easy to get lost in and even easier to hide something in. Besides the fields, it's normal to see tractors driving down the middle of the road or to drive by a herd of cows on the side of the road. That's enough about the town. Let's see what the teens are up to.

12 INT. SCHOOL LIBRARY - CONTINUOUS 12

NARRATOR
Oh look, Alex is skipping third-period gym class.

Alex sits in the sci-fi section.

NARRATOR (cont'd)

Alex sits in the sci-fi section, "Alex's textbooks", Cooper would say. Mrs. Less sees him. She knows the few kids she sees during the day pretty well. Now, Mrs. Less loves all things supernatural. Not that I can recommend her type of vampire books. She knows why Alex is here. She knows all too well about why Alex likes reading about other worlds. Alex used to come in here and talk her ear off about his day, that was until he found out they didn't have student-teacher confidentiality. Now, he just tells her about the books he's had his nose buried in recently.
We can leave Alex here. He'll be here for a while.
(MORE)

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NARRATOR (cont'd)
He doesn’t "really" need to go to fourth period. Don’t worry, he’s happy being alone here.

13 INT. ENGLISH CLASS - LATER - BEAT 3 13

Cooper is in Mrs. Smith’s English class.

NARRATOR
Cooper is in Mrs. Smith’s English class. He tries to focus, he really would love to care but, right now all he can think about is the rumor he heard about that old abandoned house at the end of Poplar Court. According to Matthew, Sarah told Chris who told Cooper last night at the bowling alley. Matthew told Sarah that during his paper route he could hear crying coming from inside the house. Chris doesn’t remember if Sarah said a little girl crying or just crying but the point is that it is still weird. Crying is coming from the big old abandoned house that kids dare each other to knock on. Like that one book cooper read for his book report last year. Maybe cooper should pay attention in this class more. Listener, I think that is all we need from Cooper for now. Let’s skip to 11a.m., lunch time.

14 INT. THE SCHOOL CAFETERIA - LATER 14

Mike and Cooper sit at lunch, alone.

Alex again hasn’t shown.

Cooper sighs.

COOPER
Library again?

Mike nods. They stand.

As MIKE passes LUCAS BEERY’S lunch table, LUCAS sticks out a foot.

MIKE TRIPS.

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His MASON JAR OF CHOCOLATE MILK slips from his hands and SHATTERS across the floor.

The cafe goes quiet. A few kids SNICKER.

Mike clenches his fists. He looks at Lucas — furious — but says nothing.

Mike takes a breath, swallows his anger.

He turns and walks away.

As he does, a SINGLE TEAR slips down his face.

15 INT. SCHOOL LIBRARY - MOMENTS LATER 15

Mike and Cooper sit at a table with ALEX. Books are open, but no one is reading.

Silence.

ALEX
Flagpole after school?

Mike nods.

COOPER
The club has a mission.

They exchange serious looks.

16 EXT. MAIN STREET - 4:20 PM 16

COOPER rides his bike down Main Street.

ALEX rolls alongside on his SKATEBOARD, gripping the back of Cooper’s bike seat.

That’s how they ride.

Just behind them, MIKE pedals his BLACK BMX — flames painted on the sides by Cooper.

COOPER
Sophia told Chris.
Chris told me.
Matthew heard it this morning.

The bikes roll fast.

COOPER (cont'd)
The Mystery Club needs answers.

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They turn the corner.

17 EXT. POPLAR COURT - NIGHT - BEAT 4 17

Alex lets go of the bike, he rides up to the bus stop and sits to wait for Mike to catch up.

ALEX
I’m not going in there!

Mike rolls his eyes.

MIKE BROWN
Fine, take watch or something, be useful. Make sure Officer Michaels doesn’t come sticking his nose around here.

Cooper turns to a conflicted Mike Brown

COOPER
I mean, you’re still gonna go in there with me right?

MIKE BROWN
Shit I guess I have to now.

NARRATOR
That's how their friend group worked. Alex is the brains, Cooper is the Brave, Mike is the brawn.

Cooper and Mike leave their bikes with Alex, who hands Cooper one of his walkie-talkies.

Cooper heads to the front of the house, while Mike checks the back for an open window or door.

As Cooper scans the boarded-up windows, Mike uses his strength to pry at the boards on the back door.

When he finally yanks one free, the door frame bursts open, sending the teens tumbling backward.

A thick, swirling black mist pours out, clouding the air. Dazed, they fall to the ground.

Mike recovers first and looks up at the door frame, freezing in shock.

A little girl, no more than six or seven, stands there.

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Her tear-streaked face and long hair frame her faded pink onesie.

JUNIPER
No! My monsters!

She throws her hands up.

JUNIPER (cont'd)
You must capture them! There’s the Fishie and the Man-Man.

MIKE BROWN
(baffled)
The Fishie? Greenville only has one pond but nothing’s living in there.

Juniper slowly walks up to them and tugs on Cooper’s sleeve.

JUNIPER
We have to hurry!

Cooper’s eyes look back up at the house.

The door they pried open is now a double-wide hole

COOPER
They’ve escaped, Which way?

Cooper mumbles sensing adventure

COOPER (cont'd)
Which way would they go?

Juniper looks at the sky for answers. She seems to be listening for something.

JUNIPER
The Fishie’s going to the pond. The Man-Man’s heading, somewhere.

Cooper looks at Mike.

COOPER
Sounds like a mission for the Mystery Club!

Mike raises an eyebrow.

MIKE BROWN
You want to go get Alex?

COOPER
Yeah, lets go get him.

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Cooper nods.

They hurry to the bus stop, where Alex is waiting, reading a comic book.

Cooper calls out to Alex as they walk over.

COOPER (cont'd)
Alex! We need your help! Juniper says there are monsters, one’s at the pond, the other is lost.

Alex looks at Juniper, confused.

ALEX
Cooper... why are you holding hands with a fuu-freaking little girl. Um, where did you find that little girl?

Cooper raised Juniper's hand into the air.

COOPER
We found her in the house!

Alex shakes his head as he processes.

ALEX
She’s, like, seven! What do you mean you found her!

Juniper looks at him, and Alex locks eyes with her. He wants to help her. Alex can’t hesitate.

ALEX (cont'd)
Fine.

Juniper’s eyes light up with relief.

JUNIPER
Thank you.

Cooper nods

COOPER
Alright, you and I are going after the Fishie. Mike, you’re on the Man-Man.

Mike grins.

MIKE BROWN
Let’s do it!

As Cooper starts to petal. Alex from the back of the bike.

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ALEX
Hope the Man-Man doesn't outsmart him.

Juniper tugs at Cooper's sleeve.

JUNIPER
We need to hurry. They're still close.

Cooper pedals faster.

18 EXT. FISHER POND - LATER - BEAT 5 18

NARRATOR
Cooper gets to Fisher Pond pretty fast as he and his dad used to go here a lot when he was a kid. Now, Fisher Pond is not nearly the site he remembers, now it's filled with chemicals and another dump.

Juniper from the package rack on Cooper's bike with a finger pointed at the pond.

JUNIPER
He's in there

Alex dismounts his skateboard and starts to walk to the pond.

ALEX
So, how big is this fishie?

Alex turns his head to Juniper as he walks.

JUNIPER
He is about the height of a refrigerator.

ALEX
You sure you are not American with a measuring unit like that?

As Alex gets close to the pond. A person stands up from the water, about 20 feet from the edge.

POND GUY (FISHIE)
Hey! Kid! Get out of here. Some of us are trying to sleep!

Alex turns to meet the voice

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ALEX
Who the hell!?! Hey, man... so I was sent here to kill a fish man.

At these words, the man jumps back into the water.

From the top of the hill, Cooper calls down with a grin,

COOPER
Good one!

Alex groans and throws his hands up.

ALEX
Well, I didn't exactly ask for a chat, did I?

Juniper shakes her head, but there's a glimmer of amusement in her eyes.

JUNIPER
You scared him off. But that's actually good,
(she steps forward.)
We need him to come closer, to get his head out of the water.

Alex eyes her suspiciously.

ALEX
What do you mean?

Juniper's expression is serious again.

JUNIPER
I can grab him, if you two can trick him into coming to the surface. Make him think you're leaving, like you're giving up. Get him to poke his head up and look around. That's when I'll do it.

Cooper, from behind, watches intently.

COOPER
Wait, so you can just grab him? Like… with your mind or something?

Juniper nods.

JUNIPER
Exactly. I'll hold him above the water. You just need to get him close enough.
(MORE)

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JUNIPER (cont'd)
But make sure you don’t get caught. He won’t exactly be happy when I catch him.

Alex looks at Juniper, still not sure how to feel about all this.

ALEX
Alright, but what happens when you grab him? You just hold him there?

Juniper hesitates slightly, before nodding.

JUNIPER
He’ll… start to draw air in, like he’s drowning. He won’t survive like that for long.

Alex’s brow furrows.

ALEX
Wait, you’re just gonna… kill him?

JUNIPER
No...no. He isn't dead. He’s just… going back where he belongs.

Alex exchanges a look with Cooper, both of them unsure about what she means, but decide this is too cool of an experience to stop.

The boys positioned themselves by the water’s edge, preparing to draw the Fishie’s attention.

They start to turn their backs and step away, deliberately slow.

The fish man watches them from the water, and after a tense moment, he lifts his head above the surface, curious.

FISHIE
That’s what I thought! Scram Kid!

That’s when Juniper moves.

She focuses, and her eyes glow briefly as the Fishie is suddenly pulled from the water, held mid-air by some invisible force.

The Fishie struggles, flailing against the unseen grip, but Juniper’s concentration is unyielding.

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He thrashes, but it’s no use. He begins to gasp, inhaling air he doesn’t want, as his body starts to glow, his form disintegrating into light. The Fishie lets out one final strangled sound as his body turns into a beam of light. With a final explosion of light, he’s gone.

Alex and Cooper stare at the empty space in shock.

ALEX
Is he-?

JUNIPER
Don't worry.
He is exactly where he belongs.

Cooper gives a low whistle.

COOPER
That was… awesome!

Juniper’s gaze is steady.

JUNIPER
I told you. We can’t let them run free.

Alex hesitates, still processing what just happened.

ALEX
So… what now?

19 EXT. MAIN STREET - NIGHT - BEAT 6 19

They are back on their way toward the house.

Alex’s walkie-talkie crackles to life.

ALEX
(Into the walkie-talkie)
“Hello!?! What’s up!?!”

MIKE BROWN (O.C.)
I think I found him at the playground.

Alex jokes back.

ALEX
Good joke! On the seesaw?

Mike, now serious

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MIKE BROWN
I’m looking at an 8-foot tall green monster in the sand pit.

Surprised, Alex and Cooper look at each other as Alex slowly brings the walkies-talkie to his mouth.

ALEX
Does he have metal sticking out of his neck?

MIKE BROWN (O.C.)
Yeah, how did you know?

Alex sighs.

ALEX
Because he's Frankenstein.

They turn around and head to the school.

Mike's voice pours in from the walkies-talkie

MIKE BROWN
Good news, I’m friends with Frank! Bad news, he’s chasing me! I’m riding down Main Street with a 8 foot Monster chasing me. I asked him if he wanted to play tag,so.. now I'm taking him to the house.

20 EXT. OUTSIDE THE HOUSE - MOMENTS LATER - BEAT 7 20

Alex and Cooper, going faster than they probably ever have, turn onto Poplar Court.

ALEX
This is my stop.

Alex lets go of the rack and rolls to a stop at the same bus stop from earlier.

COOPER
Come on man!

ALEX
I’m not going in there!

Cooper rolls his eyes and yells back as he jumps off his bike into a sprint.

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COOPER
(over his shoulder)
Fine, but I’m going to see a Frankenstein!

21 INT./EXT. THE HOUSE ON POPLAR COURT - CONTINUOUS 21

He enters a hole in the house and finds Mike in a corner, with Frankenstein napping on the floor.

MIKE BROWN
(nervously staring at the monster)
The big guy got tired.

Juniper, seizing the moment, raises a glowing hand, blinding them. When they regain their sight, she apologizes, revealing.

JUNIPER
I’m not human. I’m a Throughout, and those creatures were prisoners from beyond your universe. You broke the seal and set them free!

As the house shakes, the Throughouts descend the stairs, pulling glowing orbs from their pockets.

JUNIPER (cont'd)
You’ve seen too much. But worry not, my superiors tell me they are going to spare you, you won’t even notice the difference.

Juniper, with a flick of her hand, tosses the flowing orb up to the ceiling, on cue the Throughouts throw the orbs, flooding the room with light.

22 EXT. THE BUS STOP - CONTINUOUS 22

Alex hears a crumbling sound and watches in horror as the house sinks into a massive hole. He runs toward it as if he can stop this but his legs betray him and he falls. When he looks up, the house is gone, just a patch of grass and a mailbox remain.

THE END